



Fire safety in the home

Overview

Fire safety in the home comprises a set of five units; *Fire safety in the home*, *Make your home safe*, *Bedtime safety checks*, *Fire!* and *Fire safety in the home - research and revision*. These units aim to support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to:

- recognise common causes of fires
- make their homes as safe as possible
- know what action to take if there is a fire and use 999 to call for the fire service if necessary.

Level: Each set of resources includes:

- activities for beginner reader writers
- activities at Entry 1 (Access 2 in Scotland)
- differentiated activities for learners at Entry 2/ Entry 3 (Access 3/Intermediate level 1 in Scotland) or higher
- ideas for extension activities

Learning hours and delivery context:

The five *Fire safety in the home* units provide a minimum of 7.5 hours of learning in a classroom context. These units can be used independently or as one linked topic over four or more sessions. If you are going to use more than unit, use them in the order provided. Timings are flexible and teachers can break the units into smaller chunks of learning and build in differentiation, revision and extension activities as required.

The resource is suitable for use in a wide range of adult ESOL learning contexts including community ESOL and FE. Additionally, the teacher notes provide suggestions on how practitioners can develop further linked learning (such as developing and working with learner-produced texts) and build links with the local fire service to further develop and support learners' skills, knowledge and confidence.

Preparation

Fire safety in the home units comprise:

1. Activities and worksheets to download and print. Key words matching sheets can be printed off, laminated and cut up to make matching activities or for learners to play pelmanism. Alternatively learners can draw lines to match the words and pictures. Key words answer sheets can be used to check answers and for beginner readers writers to recognise, read and say each key word then write over the grey version of each word and copy independently on the dotted lines.
2. On-line interactive activities which need a computer with data projector and audio speakers – these can be done independently or in pairs if there are enough computers, or projected onto the screen and done as a whole class activity
3. *Fire safety* leaflets - you can ask learners to view these on line, request copies from your local fire service or download from www.directgov.uk. The main leaflet to support activities in these units is: **Fire – make your home safe** leaflet (Entry 1+):

http://www.direct.gov.uk/prod_consum_dg/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_182673.pdf



For additional reading and research, learners with (Entry 2+/Access 3+) English can read the **Fire safety in the home** leaflet:

http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_073993.pdf

Entry 2+/Access 3+ learners who live in shared or rented accommodation, can also read the **Fire safety in shared or rented accommodation** leaflet:

http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_074034.pdf

You can also:

- collect images or newspaper stories relating to fire safety in the home
- get further information from the website for the fire service in your area, e.g. <http://www.london-fire.gov.uk/SafetyAtHome.asp>
- take a smoke alarm into the class. In some areas it is possible to request one from the local fire service
- contact your local fire service and ask if they are able to visit the centre and meet learners. Local fire services are often keen to have opportunities to meet people from the local community in order to raise awareness about fire safety. In some areas they will have forms for local residents to fill in and return requesting a fire safety visit to their homes and for a free smoke alarm to be fitted. Your local fire service may have a community liaison person who can help to arrange this.

Unit 3: Bedtime safety

Time: approximately 1.5 hours

Aims:

- To support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to make effective bedtime safety check in their homes

Objectives:

By the end of this session, all learners will:

- Say, read, write and use some key words for common household items
- Read about and identify key safety action to take at bedtime

Beginner reader writers will:

- Read, copy and use some key words for common household items

Confident Entry 1/Entry 2/Access 3 + learners will:

- Write a bedtime safety checklist

Suggested procedure

1. Set the context (all levels)

Use paper-based or on-line images of bed to elicit ideas, suggestions and comments about the main topic – bedtime safety checks. Ask prompt questions such as:

- What do you do before you go bed?
- Do you make any safety checks?
- What are they?

Explain to learners they are going to learn about bedtime safety checks.

2. Bedtime safety checks – key words Entry 1/beginner reader writers

If you have a data projector:

- Project the images from *Activity 1: Key words* on to the whiteboard.
- Point at the images and elicit, model and drill the target vocabulary.
- Focus learners' attention on the key words and elicit what each word says focusing particularly on blended and single initial letter sounds.

- Learners then take it in turns to come to the whiteboard and select the correct words in each multiple choice.
- Check answers together as a whole group.

If you don't have a data projector, or as a follow up activity:

- Use realia or enlarged images from *Bedtime safety – key words* as flash cards or images projected onto the whiteboard to elicit, model and drill the target vocabulary from the *Bedtime checks – key words* worksheet.
- Learners then work individually or in pairs to match the key words and images either using laminated cards or by drawing lines on the *Bedtime checks – key words* worksheet.
- Monitor and, as necessary, elicit ideas for the answers focusing particularly first letter sounds
- Give out *Bedtime checks – key words answers*. Ask learners to check their answers individually or in pairs.
- Beginner reader writers can then read and say each word, write over the grey version of each word and then copy some or all of the key words independently on the dotted lines.

3. **Bedtime safety checks** (for mixed level group work or confident Entry 1 +)

If you have a data projector (all levels):

- Project question 1 from the *Bedtime safety checks multiple selection game* onto the whiteboard and elicit the correct answer and why.
- Divide learners into two mixed level teams – odds and evens.
- Ask each group (odds or evens) to agree and select the correct answer for each of the following six questions.
- Learners read aloud and/or listen to and repeat each statement.

If you don't have a data projector, or as a follow up activity:

- Elicit a few possible bedtime safety checks.
- Divide learners into pairs or small groups. Give out *Bedtime safety checks*. Ask learners to agree and select the correct answer for each of the questions.
- Give out *Bedtime safety checks answers* for learners to check their answers.

4. **Bedtime checklist**

- Write up key verbs on the board, i.e. *Close, Un-plug, Check, Do not, Turn off, Put*. Ask learners in their groups to take it in turns to make correct statements using the verbs. Ask the other group to say whether the sentence was correct or not. You can allocate one point for each correct, or corrected, sentence.
- Explain that learners are now going to make their own bedtime checklist to display at home.

If you have computers and a printer:

- Ask learners to work individually or in pairs to word process their checklists. Encourage learners to make the checklists as bold, colourful and visual as possible, using clipart etc.
- Encourage learners to support each other, use spell-check etc.

If you don't have computers and a printer:

- Give out copies of the *Bedtime safety checklist* pro forma or blank sheets of paper, coloured pens and, if possible, old copies of shopping catalogues with images of homes, appliances etc. (Beginner reader writers can scan through catalogues to look for images relevant to what has been covered in work on this unit and stick these on their sheets of paper with a few key verbs for instructions, e.g Check, Switch off, etc.)

All groups:

- Learners can laminate their checklists if a laminator and pouches are available. If necessary, demonstrate how to use the laminator safely.

5. Recap

- Use realia and/or images to check learning and revise key words.
- Have a whole group discussion about what learners are going to do as part of their own bedtime safety routines, adjusting language according to level, e.g.
 - *I'm going to*
 - *I'm going to remind my to*
 - *I'm going to check/make sure that etc.*

Extension activity:

- To help raise awareness about the importance of bedtime safety checks, learners can make a bedtime safety checklist display for the centre or classroom before taking their checklists home.

